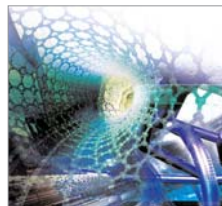


30 A Physical Presence



34 Move Over Silicon



40 The Amazing Tomatoboy!

Digital Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

Lead Feature

The Revolution Will Be Televised

More reasons to stay home, plug in, turn on and cop out. The revolution will be live over the Internet with IPTV

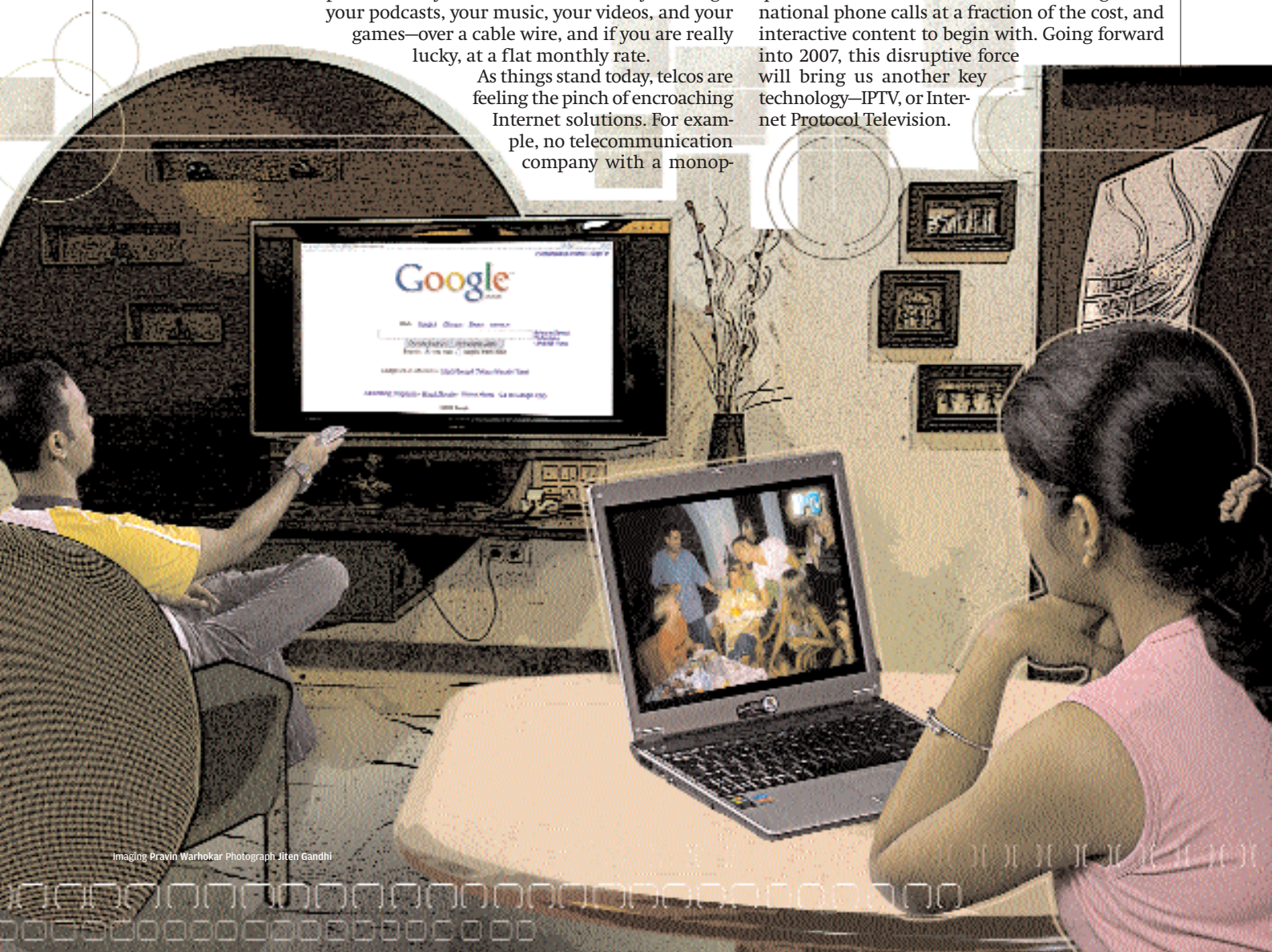
Ahmed Shaikh

Sometime between turning on the tube to Chhayageet on Doordarshan, and switching channels to spend late nights with Conan O'Brien, the Internet happened. Suddenly, we had this nebulous mesh of wires that magically connected every computer in the world with every other. If data could be broken down into IP-sized packets, it could now be transmitted over this Web. Today, you thus have a network that can bring you your work, your personal e-mails, your phone calls, your video conferences, your blogs, your podcasts, your music, your videos, and your games—over a cable wire, and if you are really lucky, at a flat monthly rate.

As things stand today, telcos are feeling the pinch of encroaching Internet solutions. For example, no telecommunication company with a monop-

oly to protect is happy over VoIP and the cheap long-distance (or even free) phone calls it delivers. But VoIP is just the tip of the iceberg: today Wi-Fi-enabled handsets can completely eliminate the need to make a phone call via the traditional channels, local or overseas. Tomorrow, when WiMAX throws a much wider wireless blanket over cities... well, it won't be the happiest time to be a telecommunications company.

While the Internet has thrown a spanner in the business machinery of many an industry—from music to telecommunication—as a disruptive technology, it is forever changing the status quo. Music downloads for 99 cents a song, international phone calls at a fraction of the cost, and interactive content to begin with. Going forward into 2007, this disruptive force will bring us another key technology—IPTV, or Internet Protocol Television.



Imaging: Pravin Warhokar Photograph: Jiten Gandhi